UU–B–690
April 10, 1967
SUPERSEDING
MIL–B–15884(S&A)
December 1, 1950

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOX, LETTER FILING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION.

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of a letter filing box.

1.2 Classification. Letter filing boxes in accordance with this specification shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

1—Letter size.
2—Legal size.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP–B–636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product. Letter filing boxes shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product except for any design modifications and additional requirements specified herein.

3.2 Materials. Materials used shall conform to the requirements specified herein. Where materials are not definitely specified, they shall be of the quality used for the purpose in commercial practice.

3.3 Design and construction. Letter filing boxes shall be one piece with a hinged drop front and a hinged cover. Each box shall contain an alphabetical index and shall be equipped with a pull tab made of leather, plastic, or coated cloth, not less than 0.050-inch thick, securely fastened on the back, and a snap or suitcase style front fastener secured to the drop front and hinged cover. The box shall have the general design and construction illustrated in figure 1. The outside of the box, with the exception of the back, shall be covered with a dark, wave or agate-marbled paper which shall continue inside the box for at least ¼ inch. The back shall be covered with an imitation leather cover paper, of a color contrasting with blue or black ink or printing. The interior of the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

box shall be lined throughout with white or blue paper, except when the box material is white- or blue-lined binder's board.

3.3.1 The top, bottom, cover, and drop front shall be made of binder's board not less than 0.080-inch thick. The sides shall be made of seasoned wood or binder's board and shall be not less than 5/16-inch thick except along the outside top surfaces which are skirted by the cover flanges. The surfaces skirted by the cover flanges shall be recessed on the outside to provide a flush exterior when the cover is closed. The back shall be made of binder's board in several thicknesses, scored and rounded, both on the exterior and interior; at least one of the thicknesses shall have brass plated steel eyelets, to receive an index retaining device. All corners shall be reinforced with metal stitches, properly set. Alternatively, the back may be made of seasoned wood not less than 11/16-inch thick, rounded on the exterior and flat on the interior; all corners shall be reinforced with cloth tape or other means used in commercial practice. The wood back shall be furnished with a device for retaining the indexing sheets.

3.3.2 The cover and the drop front of the box shall be hinged inside and out with strong buckram or twill fabric not less than 1-inch wide. The fabric shall have between 62 to 72 ends in the warp and between 38 to 44 picks in the filling. The cover shall open not less than 180° and the drop front shall open not less than 90°.

3.4 **Dimensions.** Letter filing boxes shall have the following inside dimensions in inches. A tolerance of plus or minus 1/8 inch shall apply.

Size	Length	Width	Height
1 (letter size)	11¾	10¾	2¾
2 (legal size)	14½	11	2¾

3.5 **Index.** Each letter filing box shall be furnished with an alphabetical index (A through Z) of not less than 15 leaves plus a cover leaf. The leaves shall be made of strong manila or kraft paper not less than 0.008-inch thick and shall have projecting style, printed alphabet tabs. The index shall be held in place by a single center post at the back of the letter-size box, and by two posts in the legal-size box.

3.6 **Identification marking.** Each box shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.7 **Workmanship.** The boxes shall be free from defects or imperfections which affect appearance or which might impair serviceability. Covering and lining shall be applied smoothly and uniformly without blistered areas or excessive gluing or cementing. Corners shall be completely covered and neatly made. The cover and fastener shall open and close easily.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 **Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may use his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Component and material inspection.** In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications.

4.3 **Sampling for inspection.** Sampling for inspection and lot acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL–STD–105, unless otherwise specified herein. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all boxes of one size offered for delivery at one time.

4.3.1 *End item inspection.* The sample unit shall be one complete letter filing box. The lot size shall be expressed as the number of filing boxes in the inspection lot.

4.3.1.1. *Visual examination.* The filing boxes shall be examined for the defects in table I. The inspection level shall be S–4 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be four defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2014-09-25T13:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. *Visual defects in the end item*

Examine	Defect
Design and construction	Box not one piece.
	Pull tab or front fastener missing, loose, or improperly located.
	Front fastener wrong style.
	Box not fully covered outside or fully lined inside, when required.
	Wrong kind or color of covering or lining paper.
	Covering paper does not continue to the inside.
	Cover does not overlap sides.
	Sides not recessed to provide a flush exterior with the cover closed.
	Back of box not shaped as specified.
	Corners not reinforced.
	Any material not as specified.
	Cover opens less than 180°.
	Front opens less than 90°.
Alphabetical index	Missing or not provided with retaining part.
	Less than 15 leaves plus cover leaf.
	Tabs missing or not projecting style.
	Tabs obstructed by one another.
	Leaves made from wrong material.
	Tabs not printed or printing illegible.
	Complete alphabet not printed on tabs.
Workmanship	Covering or lining paper not smoothly or neatly applied.
	Visible wrinkles, bubbles or ragged edges on covering or lining paper.
	Corners not completely covered or neatly made.
	Cover or front fastener does not open or close without binding.
	Front fastener does not secure the cover.
	Cover does not fit properly.
Identification marking	Missing or illegible.

4.3.1.2 *Dimensional examination.* The filing boxes shall be examined for specified dimensions and material thicknesses. Any deviation from specified dimensions or thicknesses shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be four defects per hundred units.

4.3.2 *Examination of the preparation for delivery.* The packaging, packing, and marking shall be examined to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5 and any special requirements in the contract or order. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot and the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packed and selected prior to the sealing operation. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects. Inspection level S-2 shall apply and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units. Examination shall be made for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE II. *Defects in preparation for delivery*

Examine	Defect
Marking (interior and exterior container)	Omitted or incomplete.
	Incorrect or illegible.
	Improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
	Any component not as specified.
Packaging	Improper method of closure.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closures of containers, flaps, strapping, or taping.
	Bulging, distorted, or damaged container.
Content (exterior container)	Number per container is more or less than required.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Each filing box shall be wrapped in kraft paper and secured with tape.

5.1.2 *Level B civil agencies:* No packaging required.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2014-09-25T13:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The filing boxes shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Filing boxes of one size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V3c or V3s of PPP–B–636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed by means of tape, and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix to PPP–B–636. The weight of contents shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2 *Level B.*

5.2.2.1 *Military.* Twelve letter size or six legal size filing boxes packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP–B–636, weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.2 *Civil agencies.* Twelve letter size filing boxes shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP–B–636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The filing boxes, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Standard packaging (civil agencies).** The standard packaging for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.2.2.2.

5.4 **Marking.**

5.4.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** Letter filing boxes are intended for use as a ready reference or pending file or for storing correspondence, invoices, etc.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Size of letter filing box required (see 1.2).

(*c*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 **Standard pack for civil agencies.** The standard pack for civil agency procurements intended for stores stock replenishments shall be in accordance with 5.3. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, or shipment to eventual user.

6.4 **Supersession data.** The requirements of Specification MIL–B–15884(S&A) have been included in this specification as size 2.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—69

Review Activities:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—69

User Activities:

Army—GL
Navy—CG
Air Force—69

Preparing Activity:

Navy—SA

CIVIL AGENCY INTEREST:

GSA–FSS

Review/user information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2014-09-25T13:54Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

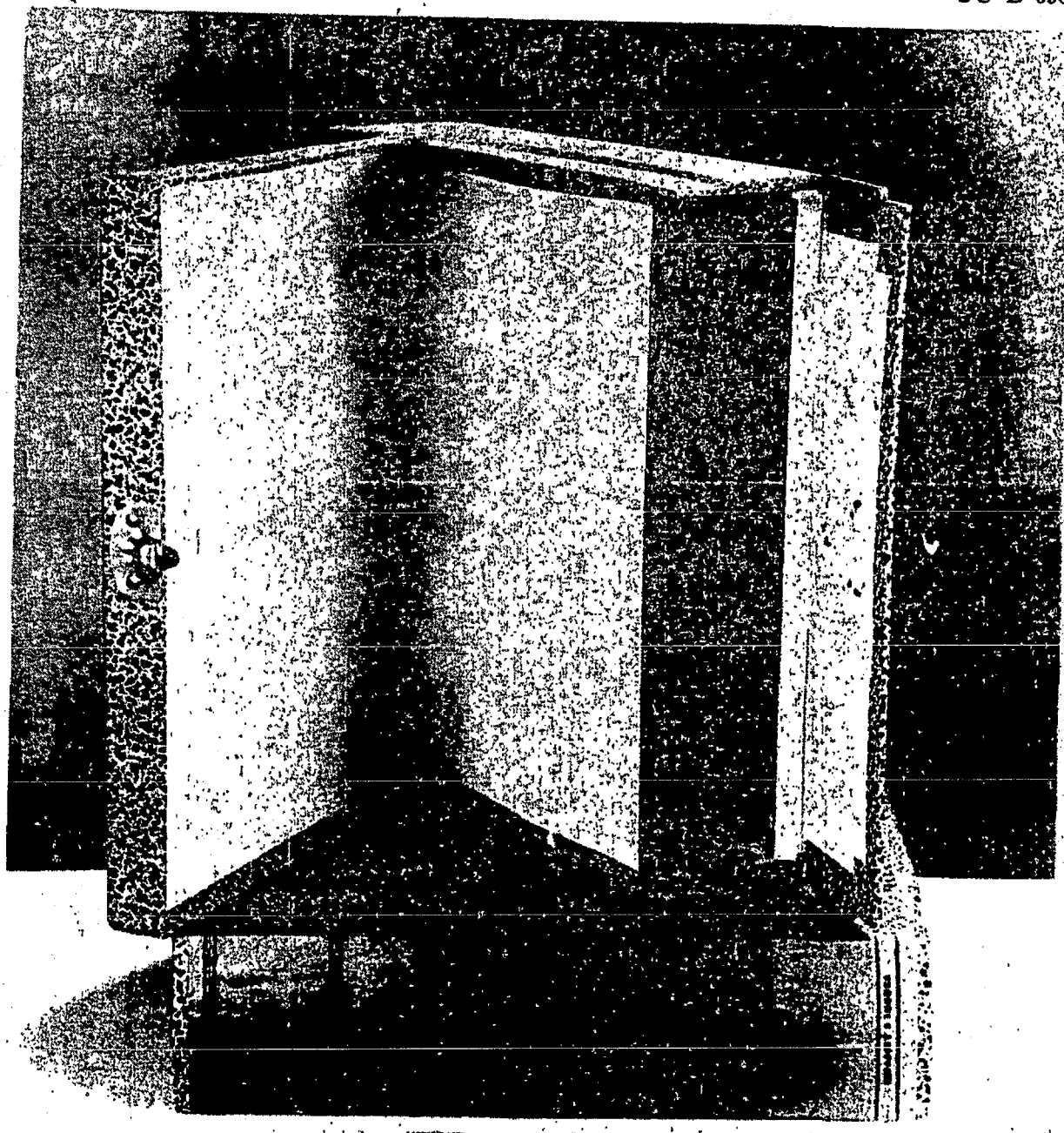


FIGURE 1. Box, LETTER FILING

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.